

Yes. With the two literature slides and the merge of the former slides 13–14, I think the architecture becomes much cleaner. I would also make one other adjustment: **the early “contribution” slide should tease the database, but not already exhaust all the descriptive statistics**. Otherwise the beginning and the first results slide become repetitive.

The resulting balance is good for the kind of project you have: roughly **6 slides to establish the question/gap, 7 slides on measurement and data construction, 5–6 stylized-fact slides, and one strong closing slide**. In other words, the method is clearly part of the empirical contribution rather than a short technical interlude.

The logic is supported by the work itself. Your methodology is not simply “LLM extraction”: it constructs two distinct objects—a census that supplies the denominator and an allocation layer that records statutory routing—and then joins them to measure prevalence correctly. Your taxonomy further shows why the legal classification is substantive: an unrestricted territorial assignment is **not** an earmark, while partial and exclusive earmarks are different instrument-level objects. And your literature synthesis explicitly concludes that the corpus does **not** establish a causal effect of earmarking on net DRM in SSA and that no representative SSA inventory currently establishes prevalence or design. That gives us a very coherent reason for putting measurement at the center.

Proposed architecture table

The “visual” column below is still conceptual. We are **not designing the slide yet**; we are deciding what kind of evidence should dominate it.

#	Working slide title	Core claim / job of the slide	Content / evidence	Visual concept	What stays mainly oral
1	On the Pros and Cons of Earmarking Taxes in SSA	Introduce the question, not the answer	Title, subtitle, name/team	Very minimal title slide	One-sentence definition of the project
2	SSA needs more domestic revenue	Establish why the DRM question matters	Development financing needs; slow DRM progress; declining external support/grants	One strong macro chart + 1–2 large numbers	Broader DRM background
3	Why constrain revenue when fiscal space is already tight?	Introduce the central earmarking puzzle	Potential gains: political acceptability, trust/visibility, priority funding. Potential costs: rigidity, fragmentation, inefficient allocation	A restrained tension / trade-off composition, not a pros-cons table	Examples of why governments may nevertheless choose earmarks
4	Earmarking can affect several	Literature slide 1: show mechanisms	De jure design → political authorization → revenue realization → budget translation →	One simple transmission chain	Mention key literature behind each mechanism,

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	stages of the fiscal process	rather than papers	expenditure quality / outcomes , with budget-wide costs around the chain		but don't list 15 citations on-slide
5	The evidence is mixed—and particularly thin for SSA	Literature slide 2: establish what is known and unknown	Stronger evidence for political authorization; uncertain compliance/net revenue effect; mixed additionality; expenditure effects conditional on governance/PFM; no causal SSA-wide DRM result	Perhaps a 5-row evidence matrix : mechanism / evidence / conclusion	Individual studies and qualifications
6	A more basic question remains unanswered: where is earmarking actually used?	Convert the literature gap into your empirical question	No representative inventory of prevalence, sources, statutory destinations or legal design across SSA; standard revenue data do not recover destination	Lots of whitespace; perhaps ? over SSA / very simple "Revenue data → ??? → destination" visual	Explain why individual known funds are not enough to characterize prevalence
7	Contribution: a new de jure map of statutory revenue assignment in SSA	Give the audience the payoff early	19 countries + 2–3 <i>provisional/final-validated</i> headline figures; two contributions: new data + reproducible measurement method	One dominant 19 countries + 2–3 smaller numbers; possibly tiny map	Explain that results are descriptive by design: first build the measurement infrastructure
ACT II — BUILDING THE MEASUREMENT					
8	What exactly do we measure?	Define the empirical object before showing the pipeline	Current legal snapshot; de jure rather than collections/execution; broad revenue instrument concept; instrument versus allocation channel	One legal clause on left → concise definition on right	Why "revenue instrument" is broader than "tax"; legal labels vary across taxes, duties, levies, contributions, redevances, etc.
9	Not every statutory	Give the audience the	Unassigned → assigned/unrestricted →	A clean horizontal	Technical E0–E4 names can stay

#	Working slide title	Core claim / job of the slide	Content / evidence	Visual concept	What stays mainly oral
	assignment is an earmark	taxonomy needed to understand everything that follows	partial earmark → exclusive earmark ; cost recovery set aside. 2–3 real examples	taxonomy with examples underneath	oral/appendix unless useful
10	The legal source architecture differs across countries	Establish why extracting this information is difficult	Francophone: usually consolidated CGI + extensions. Anglophone: multiple tax, levy, fund and finance Acts; source and assignment may occur in different texts	Two-column Francophone / Anglophone comparison, using document fragments rather than boxes	Details on document manifest and source selection
11	Measuring prevalence requires two linked databases	Present the central architecture of the method	Revenue Instrument Census → denominator ; Statutory Allocation Layer → destinations ; linked through census_ref	The main methodology diagram: two branches converging	Explain why one multi-beneficiary instrument must count once in prevalence but several times as allocation channels
12	Step 1 — Reconstruct the universe of revenue instruments	Explain the census branch	Search charge-creating provisions → extract instruments → reconcile duplicate/amended statements → current instrument census	Actual clause → structured row → country census	Detailed identity/rate rules
13	Step 2 — Find sparse allocation clauses without losing recall	Explain the allocation branch and why it is deliberately staged	LOCATE → EXTRACT → RECONCILE ; source and destination may be separated by pages or Acts; one destination = one allocation channel	Actual allocation clause + short pipeline	Prompt engineering specifics, model/interface, file handling
14	From legal evidence to comparable—and auditable—data	Merged former slides 13 + 14: show enrichment + validation together	Join to census; classify taxed base/sector; classify destination function/COFOG; resolve latest/current statements; retain article/page/verbatim	One example moving from raw legal evidence → final analytical observation , with	Detailed QA rules; residual false-negative risk; specific validation exercises

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			evidence; coverage checks and human review	validation marks attached	
		ACT III — WHAT DOES THE NEW INVENTORY REVEAL?			
15	The database covers X revenue instruments and Y statutory allocation channels across 19 countries	Establish sample/data anatomy before ratios	Country coverage; Francophone/Anglophone composition; census instruments; assigned instruments; allocation channels; earmarked instruments	Map + a few clean summary counts or a compact sample chart	Coverage qualifications by legal architecture
16	How prevalent is statutory earmarking across countries?	Headline extensive-margin fact	Country-level N/D : distinct census instruments with an earmark / current census instruments	Main cross-country prevalence chart	Explain denominator/corpus caveats; this is a share of instruments, not revenue
17	Earmarking is not binary: some instruments are only partially dedicated	Exploit something your new taxonomy uniquely reveals	E0/E1/E2/E3 composition or, among earmarks, partial vs exclusive	Country-level or pooled stacked bars / dot plot	Why decentralization without use restriction is not “partial earmarking”
18	What kinds of revenue instruments are earmarked?	Describe the source side economically	Tax/revenue categories; taxed bases/sectors; perhaps economy-wide vs sector-specific	One clear distribution; possibly cross-country comparison	Detailed instrument-nature mapping
19	What do governments earmark revenue for?	Describe the destination side	Destination functions/COFOG: health, education, transport, environment, etc.; recipient forms if useful	Dominant destination chart	Classification details and multi-function cases

#	Working slide title	Core claim / job of the slide	Content / evidence	Visual concept	What stays mainly oral
20	What does the legal design of earmarks look like?	Use the strongest remaining structural fact	To select after final results audit: allocation density, dedication ratio, destination forms, payer–beneficiary link, stated shares, routing depth, etc.	Depends on chosen fact	Remaining secondary design dimensions
21	Ghana: from statutory earmarking to its budget footprint (conditional)	Use a country case to go one layer beyond the legal inventory	Legal earmarked funds matched to budget allocations; evolution/composition where correspondence is defensible	One or two time-series / composition visuals	Why this is a case illustration, not directly comparable causal evidence across the full sample
22	What this project establishes—and what remains to be studied	Close on contribution rather than apology	Establishes: prevalence, legal sources, destinations, design heterogeneity. Does not establish: collections, compliance, additionality, expenditure quality, causal effects. Bottom: <i>de jure inventory → execution → additionality → outcomes</i>	Three concise takeaways + small forward arrow	Future panel/history, revenue/expenditure matching, causal research

The legal definition behind slides 8–9 is particularly important. Your methodology requires both a revenue source and an **enacting assignment clause**; merely finding a fund or a policy statement does not establish an earmark. And your current taxonomy gives a clean presentation distinction: E1 is assigned but unrestricted, E2 partial earmarking, and E3 exclusive earmarking; unrestricted decentralization must not be counted as partial earmarking.

Why I think this architecture works better

The first major improvement is the **two-slide literature sequence**. I agree with you there. One literature slide would force you either to make a superficial pros/cons list or to overload the slide. The two slides now perform two different jobs:

Slide 4 asks: *Through what mechanisms could earmarking matter?*

Slide 5 asks: *What has the literature actually established?*

That distinction is exactly in your literature synthesis. The conceptual chain separates *de jure* design, political authorization, collection, transfer, marginal spending and expenditure quality, while the evidence assessment says the SSA prior is strongest for a short-run authorization mechanism, much weaker for compliance, conditional for additionality, and uncertain for expenditure-quality/system-wide effects.

Most importantly, **slide 5 creates slide 6**. You don't abruptly say "there is no database." The audience reaches that conclusion naturally:

We don't have a causal answer → the SSA evidence itself is sparse → we don't even know the basic distribution of the treatment → therefore we first need to measure it.

That is a strong research narrative.

The methodology now has the right weight

Slides **8–14 are seven substantive slides**. That does not feel excessive here because each addresses a separate measurement problem:

object → classification → corpus → database architecture → denominator extraction → allocation extraction → comparability/validation.

This is very different from spending seven slides describing a prompt.

Your methodology document supports that distinction: the census and earmark branches solve different search problems, with the census seeking charge-creating provisions and the earmark branch seeking sparse assignment clauses with greater concern for false negatives.

I particularly like your proposed **merge of the former slides 13 and 14**. Classification and validation belong together conceptually:

"We don't just recover legal text; we transform it into comparable analytical variables while preserving an audit trail back to the source."

That is much stronger than one slide called "classification" followed by one slide called "validation."

I would remove the dedicated "LLM setup" slide

I would still mention the LLM prominently, but I would **embed it in slides 11–14**.

For example, slide 13 could have a small line at the bottom:

LLM-assisted extraction using fixed stage-specific prompts, governing data dictionaries, decision rules, positive/negative examples, and structured outputs.

Then orally:

"For this pilot I implemented the pipeline using Claude through the interactive interface; the stages and schemas are model/interface-independent and can be moved to an API workflow."

That is enough.

Why? Because the research contribution is **not that Claude Opus was used through chat instead of an API**. The contribution is the extraction architecture, definitions, units, reconciliation logic, auditability and new data it produces. Spending a whole slide on implementation risks making the work look *more* like an AI engineering demo and *less* like an empirical measurement contribution.

The detailed model, prompt structure, interface and API scalability are very good **appendix / Q&A** material.

I would keep the taxonomy slide simple

Your underlying taxonomy is sophisticated, but slide 9 should **not reproduce it**.

The audience needs only:

No observed statutory assignment → assigned, unrestricted → partial earmark → exclusive earmark

with **cost recovery outside**.

Your full taxonomy then supports the later stylized facts. For instance, it separately defines structural fullness, the actual dedication ratio, legal determinacy, routing depth, recipient type, function and payer–beneficiary linkage. Those become candidate result dimensions, not material that all has to appear on the taxonomy slide.

Slides 15–20 should still be decided only after a “results audit”

I would **not lock the five stylized-fact slides yet** beyond the first four questions:

How prevalent?

Partial or exclusive?

What is earmarked?

What is it earmarked for?

Those are clearly justified by the database design.

Slide 20 should be chosen after we look at all your computed results and ask: **which additional fact changes how we understand earmarking?**

Maybe it is:

one instrument often feeds several destinations;

or:

many legal earmarks specify the destination but not a fully computable share;

or:

payer–beneficiary linkage is much less common than the classic benefit-principle literature would suggest;

or something else.

We should let the data decide rather than deciding now that there “must” be a sixth graph.

Ghana is valuable, but I would make it conditional

I like Ghana as the last empirical slide because it serves a different function from another cross-country descriptive statistic.

The cross-country inventory answers:

What does the law assign?

Ghana potentially begins asking:

How large is this legal architecture in budgetary terms?

That is exactly the natural next empirical layer. But I would only keep it in the main deck if the matching between the legal earmarks and the budget categories is sufficiently clean. Otherwise it becomes an appendix/case-study extension and slide 20 becomes your final result.

One important adjustment to your teaser numbers

I would **not yet write** on slide 7:

"435 earmarks: 226 decentralization + 209 real earmarks."

The terminology is now inconsistent with your final taxonomy.

Your taxonomy explicitly says unrestricted decentralization is **assigned but unrestricted (E1)**, *not an earmark*. Earmarked instruments are E2 + E3.

So the eventual slide should say something more like:

435 revenue instruments with a statutory allocation
209 purpose-restricted earmarked instruments
803 statutory allocation channels

if those numbers survive the final taxonomy and validation.

Then, if 226 corresponds precisely to assigned-but-unrestricted instruments, that can be labelled accordingly. But first we need to make sure the counts are at the same grain and that cost-recovery-only cases are treated consistently.

That precision is actually a strength of your project.

So at this point, **Stage 1 — narrative architecture is almost finished**. I would consider slides **1–14 and 22 provisionally locked**. Slides **15–21 are structurally defined but their empirical content still needs selection and verification**.

The next task should therefore be very concrete: **build the asset/content sheet for slides 1–14**—for each one, determine the exact numbers, citations, legal examples, and source material we will actually use. At the same time, we can do a separate **results audit** to choose the final stylized facts for slides 15–20. That is the last step before we start designing the visual system.